such as temporary permits, break-glass procedures with rigorous auditing, or manual verification by an authorized reviewer. These exceptions should be infrequent, limited in duration, and thoroughly logged for future review.

16.9.3 Governance responsibilities

Governance determines who ACME trusts, for what purposes, and under which conditions. As chapter 14 emphasized, separating policy from governance maintains consistent authorization while allowing the trust framework to evolve.

Several responsibilities fall naturally into place:

- **Identity team:** Assesses governance frameworks and issuer accreditation models, manages the trust store, sets assurance levels, and determines acceptable credential types for various access decisions.
- **Integration and signals team (responsible for the PIP):** Maintains issuer metadata, revocation endpoints, schema mappings, and the normalized attribute definitions that policies depend on. This team ensures that trust and confidence information flows smoothly into the enforcement pipeline.
- **Authorization platform teams (responsible for the PEPs): Operate the systems that understand and respond to credential presentation protocols supported by ACME. This team makes sure the correct claims are requested during access, validates the resulting presentations, checks signatures and revocation status, enforces freshness requirements, and normalizes verified attributes before passing them to the PDP for policy evaluation.**
- **Policy engineering team:** Expresses business requirements in terms of normalized attributes instead of issuer identifiers, protocol constructs, or credential schemas. This approach maintains the stability of policy logic even as the ecosystem of issuers and credential types expands.

Governance ensures that ACME can adopt new issuers or credential types without rewriting policies or changing application code. It also provides the formal framework needed to review these trust decisions over time.